

Merle Mirjam Reimann

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Experience

- 09/2025 - ongoing **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *KTH Royal Institute of Technology, Sweden*: Working on human-robot interaction as part of the TECoSA applications track.
- 04/2025 - 09/2025 **Visiting Researcher**, *Bielefeld University, Germany*: Computational Linguistics. Visiting Bielefeld University on a SAIL scholarship.
- 01/2021 - 04/2025 **Ph.D. Student**, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands, Hybrid Intelligence Centre*: Social AI group. Working on dialogue management in human-robot interaction, with a focus on the communication of the robot's conversational capabilities.
- 02/2020 - 07/2020 **Research assistant**, *Bielefeld University, Germany*: CITEC, RATIO Coord. Extracting information on glaucoma and diabetes from medical abstracts. The annotations were used to test the performance of an automated extraction tool.
- 06/2019 - 12/2019 **Research assistant**, *Bielefeld University, Germany*: "Unbiased Bots That Build Bridges". Researching about social bots and programming the back-end of an application used to collect data and present the project work.

Education

- 01/2021 - 09/2025 **Human-Robot Interaction (Ph.D.)**, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Hybrid Intelligence Centre (Netherlands)*,
Thesis title: Speaking the Same Language: Spoken Capability Communication in Human-Agent and Human-Robot Interaction,
Supervisors: Koen Hindriks (VU Amsterdam), Florian Kunneman (Utrecht University), Catharine Oertel (TU Delft)
- 04/2024 - 06/2024 **Research visit**, *KTH Royal Institute of Technology, Stockholm, Sweden*, Planned and conducted an in-person human-robot interaction study with 120 participants
- 10/2018 - 10/2020 **Intelligent Systems (M.Sc.)**, *Bielefeld University (Germany)*, double degree program, Thesis: Testing Botometer with Twitter bots of different complexity, *final grade: 1.0 (GPA: 4.0)*
- 10/2018 - 10/2020 **Computer Science (M.Sc.)**, *University of Bologna (Italy)*, double degree program, semester abroad at Bologna University 09/2019 - 01/2020, *final grade: con lode*
- 09/2017 - 02/2018 Semester abroad at *Linköping University (Sweden)*
- 10/2015 - 09/2018 **Cognitive Science (B.Sc.)**, *University of Osnabrück (Germany)*, Thesis: Measuring vMMN, P300 and AEPs with a mobile EEG system, *final grade: 1.2 (with distinction) (GPA: 3.8)*

Summer Schools and Research Programs

- 06/2024 **RPL Summer School**. A five-day summer school on Robotics Perception and Learning
- 12/2022 **HRI Winterschool on Embodied AI**. A three-day winter school on embodied AI and Human-Robot Interaction
- 09/2022 **18th Workshop on Spoken Dialogue Systems for PhDs, PostDocs & New Researchers (YRRSDS)**. The Young Researcher's Roundtable for Spoken Dialogue Systems offers an open forum for early career researchers to discuss their work and spoken dialogue systems in general, by presenting a poster and participating in roundtable discussions

- 04/2022 **Lorentz Workshop on Artificial Social Intelligence.** A four-day workshop with the aim to discuss Artificial Social Intelligence and set a roadmap for the coming years for it
- 11/2021 **Winterschool on Humans & Technology.** A five-day winter school on humans and AI

Teaching

Master's Courses

11/2025 - 12/2025	Social Robotics, KTH Royal Institute of Technology	Teaching support
11/2024	Socially Intelligent Robotics, VU Amsterdam	Guest Lecturer
11/2023	Socially Intelligent Robotics, VU Amsterdam	Guest Lecturer
11/2023	Conversational Agents, TU Delft	Guest Lecturer

Bachelor's Courses

01/2025	Project Conversational Agents, VU Amsterdam	Teaching support
01/2024	Project Conversational Agents, VU Amsterdam	Teacher
01/2023	Project Multi-Agent Systems, VU Amsterdam	Teaching support

Student Supervision

Master's thesis

01/2026 - ongoing	Yogie Permana , Bridging the gap: Interaction Strategies for Managing LLM Response Delays in Spoken Human–Robot Interaction
10/2022 - 08/2023	Brian Dmyszewicz , A Crowdsourced Data Collection Infrastructure for Conversational Agents
02/2023 - 07/2023	Nina van Gulik , User Experience and Satisfaction with a Conversational Wine Recommendation System on a Pepper Robot: Insights from a Small Supermarket Study

Bachelor's thesis

04/2023 - 08/2023	James Coenraad , Making a Conversational Agent for Recipe Recommendation More Robust
05/2023 - 07/2023	Thijs Blom , Enhancing Conversational Repair Strategies in a Recipe Selection Agent

Scholarships and Funding

Scholarships

05/2025 - 09/2025	SAIL bridging scholarship , for a research visit in Bielefeld, Germany, 10,000€
04/2024 - 06/2024	Erasmus , for a research Visit at KTH (Sweden), 1,620€
09/2019 - 09/2020	Stiftung Studienfonds OWL (Deutschlandstipendium) , a scholarship of for high-achieving students, 300€ per month
09/2019 - 01/2020	Erasmus , for a semester abroad at the University of Bologna (Italy), 1,937€
09/2017 - 02/2018	Erasmus , for a semester abroad at Linköping University (Sweden), 1,350€

Funding

04/2024 - 06/2024	Hybrid Intelligence Travel Fund , Funding for travel and accommodation for a research visit to KTH (Sweden), 3800€
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Organization and Reviewing

Workshop Organization	Workshop on Designing Transparent and Understandable Robots (D-TUR) , HRI 2026
	Multidisciplinary Perspectives on COntext-aware embodied Spoken Interactions (MP-COSIN) , RO-MAN 2023

Reviewing HRI ('24, '25, '26), AAI ('24, '25), ICSR ('24), RO-MAN ('23, '24, '25), THRI ('24, '25, '26)

Outreach and Public Engagement

04/2026 Talking Robotics

09/2018 Mentor at a Kid's Hackathon with a Calliope Mini for children aged 10-12

Selected Talks

11/2025 "What Can You Say to a Robot?", at the Social Robotics Lab, Uppsala University, Sweden

07/2025 "Spoken Capability Communication in Human-Agent and Human-Robot Interaction", at the Hybrid Intelligence Center Consortium, Netherlands

06/2025 "Speaking the Same Language", at the Computational Linguistics Lab, Bielefeld University, Germany

07/2024 "Capability Communication in Human-Robot Interaction", at the Human-oriented Machine Intelligence unit, Delft University, The Netherlands

05/2024 "Dialogue Management in Human-Robot Interaction", at the Division of Speech, Music and Hearing, KTH Royal Institute of Technology, Sweden

07/2024 "Improving the User's Capability Model", at the Socially Perceptive Computing Lab, Delft University, The Netherlands

11/2022 "Dialogue Management in Human-Robot Interaction", at WAI (bi-Weekly Artificial Intelligence meetings), Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Publications

PhD Thesis **Reimann, M. M.** (2025, September). Speaking the Same Language: Spoken Capability Communication in Human-Agent and Human-Robot Interaction

Journal Paper **Reimann, M. M.**, Kunneman, F. A., Oertel, C., & Hindriks, K. V. (2024, June). A survey on dialogue management in human-robot interaction. *ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction*, 13(2), 1-22.

Conference Papers **Reimann, M. M.**, Kunneman, F. A., Oertel, C., & Hindriks, K. V. (2025, July). Transparent Conversational Agents: The Impact of Capability Communication on User Behavior and Mental Model Alignment. In *Proceedings of the 7th ACM Conference on Conversational User Interfaces* (pp. 1-12).

Reimann, M. M., Hindriks, K. V., Kunneman, F. A., Oertel, C., Skantze, G., & Leite, I. (2025, March). What Can You Say to a Robot? Capability Communication Leads to More Natural Conversations. In *2025 20th ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI)* (pp. 708-716). IEEE.

Reimann, M., van de Graaf, J., van Gulik, N., Van De Sanden, S., Verhagen, T., Hindriks, K. (2023, December). Social robots in the wild and the novelty effect. In *International Conference on Social Robotics*.

Reimann, M. M., Oertel, C., Kunneman, F. A., Hindriks, K. V. (2023, September). Predicting Interaction Quality Aspects Using Level-Based Scores for Conversational Agents. In *Proceedings of the 23rd ACM International Conference on Intelligent Virtual Agents*.

Workshop Paper Axelsson, A., **Reimann, M. M.**, Cumbal, R., Pelikan, H. R. M., Lala, D. Why Report Failed Interactions With Robots?! Towards Vignette-based Interaction Quality Reporting. Workshop on Real-World HRI in Public and Private Spaces: Successes, Failures, and Lessons Learned (PubRob-Fails), held at the IEEE RO-MAN Conference, 2025